

Skills

Administering Nebulized Medications

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Verified the healthcare provider's order.	☐	☐	☐	
Ensured privacy and performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient and family, when present.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers.	☐	☐	☐	
Asked the patient if he or she had any drug or other allergies.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Compared the label of the medication with the information in the medication administration record (MAR) twice. Completed a third check at the patient's bedside. Checked the expiration date of the medication. Followed the Six Rights of Medication Administration.	☐	☐	☐	
Completed the appropriate patient assessment for the medication being administered.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene and donned gloves. Donned appropriate personal protective equipment (PPE) based on the patient's need for isolation precautions or the risk of exposure to bodily fluids.	☐	☐	☐	
Assembled the nebulizer per the manufacturer's instructions. When the patient would be using the nebulizer at home, explained and demonstrated the nebulizer's assembly and use.	☐	☐	☐	
Added the prescribed medication to the nebulizer cup. When a diluent was needed, also added it to the nebulizer cup.	☐	☐	☐	
Attached and secured the top of the nebulizer cup.	☐	☐	☐	

Ensured the mouthpiece or facemask was connected.

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Helped the patient to an upright position, when possible.

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Turned on the airflow and ensured that a mist had formed.

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Had the patient hold the mouthpiece between his or her lips using gentle pressure.

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1. When the patient was an infant, a child, a fatigued adult, or unable to follow instructions, used a face mask.
2. Used special adapters for a patient with a tracheostomy.

Had the patient slowly take a deep breath, inhaling a volume slightly greater than normal. Encouraged a brief, end-inspiratory pause and then had the patient exhale passively. Had the patient repeat this breathing pattern until the drug was completely nebulized. When the patient was dyspneic, encouraged him or her to breathe slowly with a normal tidal volume and to take an occasional deep breath when able.

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Tapped the nebulizer cup occasionally during treatment and toward the end of treatment.

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Monitored the patient's pulse as indicated during the procedure.

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When the medication was completely nebulized, turned off the machine.

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If steroids were nebulized, instructed the patient to rinse his or her mouth and gargle with warm water after the nebulizer treatment.

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Reassessed the patient after treatment and compared findings with preassessment information.

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Disassembled all parts of the nebulizer, shook the nebulizer cup to remove the remaining medication solution, rinsed each part in sterile water, shook off excess water, and allowed parts to air-dry completely. Stored the completely dry nebulizer cup and tubing assembly in a clean bag until its next use.

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Discarded all used supplies. Removed and disposed of gloves and performed hand hygiene.

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Provided patient teaching using the Teach Back method.

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Helped the patient into a comfortable position, and placed toiletries and personal items within reach.

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Placed the call light within easy reach and made sure the patient knew how to use it to summon assistance.

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Raised the appropriate number of side rails and lowered the bed to the lowest position.

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Documented care, patient teaching, and patient's tolerance to the therapy.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____